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Table creation

Table creation is a feature that converts a normal data range into a structured table with headers automatic formatting, filter buttons, and other useful functions. It helps us to organize, manage analyze and filter data easily

Steps to create a table:

- Enter the employee details in excel, including column headings
- select the entire data range including the column headings
- Click Insert → table
- check whether the selected range is correct
- tick my table has headers
- Excel converts the selected data into a formatted table
- Go to table design tab and select a style if regeuired.

Shortcut: Select your data and press "ctrl + T" to to create a table quickly

Advantage of table creation

- Organizes data in a structured format

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- Adds filters & sorting options to column headings
- Automatically expands when you add data directly below the table
- Make data analysis easier
- provides options for applying table styles & formatting

Normal data range V/s structured table

1. Normal data Range

- A collection of data stored in regular excel cells
- Formatting & formulas may need to be applied or copied manully
- New row may require updating formula & chart ranges
- filters must be enabled separately when needed
- Suitable for simple datasets that dont change frequently

2. Structured table

- A data range converted into a excel table using ctrl + T
- provides built-in sorting & filtering
- Automatically extends formatting & calculate column formulas in common cases

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- Expands to include new row, helping table based formulas update automatically
- Supports structured references, such as =SUM(EmployeeTable[Salary])
- Supports slicers for interactive filtering
- Ideal for growing datasets, data analysis & dashboards

Slicer:

A slicer is a visual filtering tool in Excel that allows users to filter table or pivot table data by clicking buttons representing specific values.

Unlike the normal filter dropdown, a slicer displays the available categories as a clickable buttons, making filtering easier & more interactive

Steps to insert slicer :

- Click any cell inside the excel table
- Open the table design tab
- Click table design on the ribbon
- Click Insert slicer → find & select the insert slicer option
- A dialog box appears with the available

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column names.

- Tick the checkbox beside department
- Excel creates a slicer with buttons for the available departments
- Click a department button, such as training, to display only the matching employee records.

Note : you can select multiple departments in a slicer by holding ctrl while clicking the required buttons.

Use the clear filter button on the slicer to remove the selection & show all ~~the~~ records again

Advantage of slicers :

- Makes filtering data quick & easy
- Provides a visual & interactive filtering experience
- Clearly shows which filter is select
- Allows users to filter data by clicking buttons
- Helps users explore & analyze large datasets efficiently

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Filters	Slicer
• dropdown menu in the column header • select values from a dropdown list • selected filters may be less obvious • Requires opening a dropdown • Excel tables & other supported data ranges	• separate box with clickable buttons • click buttons to filter data • selected values are visually highlighted • Allows direct clicking • Excel tables & Pivot tables

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